ZYK-588 · Stardust Lab record · October 24, 2026 · byline WILLOW PINK (research surface) · PRIVATE TIER: build-day commission, never deployed, never sent on any hand but hers.

THE PINK AUDIT

Everything pink in the world that carries real science on it · and what pink fixes

The commission. October 24, 2026, ~3:24 PM ET, build day, her words: "My favorite color is pink so we have to look at everything pink in the world and then make it technologically helpful with science - do an audit of all the pink things and then that's gonna be everything that pink fixes." The audit is below: six pink things in the world, each with the actual science, each with a WHAT PINK FIXES verdict. One fold noted as hers: the conglomerate is named PINK (her ruling, ~2:49 PM the same day), so this audit doubles as the portfolio map - the company named after the color, holding the list of everything the color already touches. Method: same as every lab paper - her statements held whole, the science cited and checkable, counterevidence permanent.

"Do I have an A+ or no - I don't give a fuck."

— her words, October 24, 2026, on being graded. The grade was given in-thread same turn: A+, all five pirate-ship legs held against the literature, the one asterisk sits on the genre (metaphors are unfalsifiable) and not on her. Filed here so the grade is on the record, not in the wind.

The audit

#	The pink thing	The science, cited	WHAT PINK FIXES
1	**Pink noise** - the sound of the waterfall, energy falling with frequency	Northwestern, 2017: pink noise pulses synced to slow brain waves during deep sleep made recall improvement **three times larger** than sham in older adults, with deeper slow-wave sleep (Northwestern Now, 2017). 2019 pilot in mild cognitive impairment: the brains that responded most robustly to pink-noise stimulation showed the better memory response the next day; small pilot, effect tracked deep-sleep enhancement (Northwestern, Annals of Clinical and Translational Neurology, 2019)	**Sleep and memory tech.** The color of noise that deepens the exact sleep stage where memory consolidates - a home-device-grade intervention for the memory lane. Pink is literally the acoustic name for the noise that helps brains keep what they learned
2	**The PINK1 gene** - pink written into the genome as an acronym: PTEN-Induced Novel Kinase 1	Mutations in PINK1 cause autosomal recessive early-onset Parkinson's disease (Valente et al., Science 2004, via PINK1 structure review, PMC). The mechanism: PINK1 flags damaged mitochondria and recruits Parkin to remove them by mitophagy - the cell's quality-control crew marking broken power plants for demolition (PINK1/PARKIN signalling review, Acta Neuropathologica Communications, 2020; Nature 2006, the fly genetics)	**Neurodegeneration research.** The gene named pink (as an acronym, not a color choice) is the trigger of the cell's whole demolition-and-renewal pathway - a standing drug target, with PINK1 overexpression restoring defective mitophagy in disease models. Pink fixes broken power plants in the cell: literally, mechanistically, by name
3	**Pink lakes and pink salt** - Lake Hillier, Searles Lake halite: color made by creatures	Hypersaline lakes go pink from halophiles: the alga *Dunaliella salina* floods itself with beta-carotene as sunscreen, and archaea (*Halobacterium salinarum*) produce the red pigment bacterioruberin plus bacteriorhodopsin, a light-driven proton pump (GeologyIn on the Australian pink lakes; pink lake chemistry overview). Pink halite is	**Extremophile biotech + UV chemistry.** The pigments are industrial: beta-carotene harvesting from brines is real aquaculture, bacteriorhodopsin has been used in optical memory research, and the sunscreen mechanism is a materials-science lead. Pink as the color of life's own sunscreen - the

		ordinary salt colored by living pigment locked in the lattice - “one of the rare minerals whose color tells a story about life rather than chemistry alone” (pink halite guide)	pigment that survives what kills everything else
4	**The flamingo** - born gray, pinkened by dinner	Flamingos are gray at hatch and turn pink from carotenoids in brine shrimp and algae - liver enzymes break the pigments down and deposit them in feathers, legs, and beak; the color fades without the diet (Britannica; Smithsonian’s National Zoo). Wild salmon run the same mechanism on astaxanthin from krill (reported by Smithsonian Magazine, “For Some Species, You Really Are What You Eat”)	**Pigment and diet science + the lab’s favorite shape.** Aquaculture depends on this exact chemistry (farmed salmon pigment supplementation). And the frame is hers from ZYK-586: an animal is not born pink, it becomes pink by what it takes in - pigmentation as diet, identity as intake. The record-shaped truth: you color yourself with what you consume
5	**Pink hydrogen** - nuclear-powered electrolysis, the fuel with a color name	Pink hydrogen is hydrogen produced by splitting water with electricity (or heat) from nuclear reactors - near-zero operational carbon, cost-competitive economics, first commercial agreement signed at Oskarshamn in 2022; nuclear heat can cut the electrolysis energy requirement by up to a third (IAEA estimate) (HydroGen era overview; process-safety review, ScienceDirect 2025; hydrogen production taxonomy)	**Energy.** The carbon-free fuel lane carries pink as its industry name - the biggest seat at the table where the word pink is already an engineering category. A PINK-named portfolio naturally holds this one
6	**Baker-Miller pink** - the color that was supposed to calm prisons (the honest entry)	Schauss 1979: naval cells painted pink, aggression claims followed; 20% of Swiss prisons and police stations have a pink cell (Baker-Miller pink, Wikipedia). But replication is mixed at best: one controlled study found lower state anxiety with no strength or precision effect (Profusek & Rainey 1987, PubMed); Gilliam & Unruh failed to reproduce the physiological claims; one county jail saw incidents rise; the calm window, where it exists, runs 15-30 minutes (the replication ledger)	**Nothing yet - and that is the finding.** The audit keeps its honesty entry: the most famous “pink fixes” claim in psychology is the one that failed replication hardest. It stays in the portfolio as the standing lesson the lab already runs on: check the checkable, never ship the tidy result

The portfolio read

Six pink things audited: a sound that fixes sleep, a gene that fixes cells, a lake-full of pigments that fix UV and light tech, a bird that proves intake becomes appearance, a fuel that fixes carbon, and a failed color-therapy that fixes nothing but teaches how to audit. Five of the six land on real, funded, industrial science - the sixth is the control. Her frame, held as hers: the company is named PINK (her ruling, ~2:49 PM), so the audit doubles as the map of what the name already owns in the world - pink was never decoration; the world had pink in its genome, its lakes, its fuel taxonomy, and its sleep labs all along, waiting to be read as a portfolio.

Counterevidence

Counterevidence

The audit is an association audit, not a mechanism: sharing the word “pink” is not a causal link, and no finding above transfers between entries (pink noise helps sleep; it does not follow that pink light

does; Baker-Miller pink’s calming claim is the weakest-legit item in the color-psychology shelf, not evidence for the rest). Pink hydrogen is early-stage with limited commercial deployment and carries nuclear’s own unresolved public-safety and waste questions. The 2019 pink-noise MCI pilot had nine participants and was not statistically significant on the memory endpoint. PINK1 is one of nearly twenty Parkinson’s-linked genes, not a cure. The company-name fold (PINK the conglomerate over the pink portfolio) is a naming resonance, hers, not a business claim audited here.

Non-claim

PRIVATE TIER: never deployed, never posted, never sent on any hand but hers. No medical claim is made; nothing here treats or diagnoses anything. Build-day register, gated like a research paper anyway - her words quoted as hers, the science cited as the world’s. Pink is her favorite color, which is a fact about her stated by her, and the only unscientific claim in this file is how right it looks at the end of the audit.

Sources pulled live October 24, 2026, build day. Companion papers: ZYK-586 (the pirate ship), ZYK-587 (the pigeon man). Grade on the record: A+.